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Real News in Real Time

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'Wait! More teachers'

...Teacher recruitment suspended to work on additional number from HH's directive

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Pupil dies for love

By Alex Maboshe

A 19-year-old Form Two pupil at Kazonde Primary School in Lumezi District has killed himself shortly after receiving counselling over a relationship with a fellow pupil.

School authorities learned of the relationship involving Clement Chibanga, now deceased and a female classmate.

It is alleged that the authorities summoned both pupils for counselling on Wednesday.

The session was conducted by the deputy Headteacher and other members of staff in the presence of the pupils' parents.

After the counselling, Chibanga left the office.

That evening, a fellow pupil found him unconscious behind the school toilets and alerted the authorities.

He was taken to Lumezi District Hospital, where he received treatment but died the following day at around 08:00 hours.

Eastern Province police commanding officer Robertson Mweemba confirmed the incident.

He said the school Headteacher, Iress Chirwa, 36, reported the matter to Lumezi Police Post at around 14:00 hours.

"Police officers visited the hospital where the deceased's body was deposited at the facility's mortuary awaiting a post-mortem to ascertain the cause of death," Mweemba said.

An inquiry file has been opened and investigations are ongoing.



Vice President Mutale Nalumango receives harvested food staff from Senior Chief Puta of the Bwile speaking people of Chiengi District during the 2026 Ubuile Traditional Ceremony in Chiengi today. Picture by Royd Sibajene ZANIS.

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Real News in Real Time

‘Let’s Have It from Jay Rox’



By Alex Maboshe

Multi-award-winning Zambian artist Jackson Banda, popularly known as Jay Rox, has released a brand-new single titled “Let’s Have It,” featuring one of the country’s fastest-rising talents, Way Dee.

The uplifting anthem is now available on all major digital platforms and is already generating buzz among fans.

Jay Rox, also known as The Lion, has built a reputation as one of the few established artists who consistently uses his platform to spotlight emerging talent, and this release continues that tradition by placing Way Dee firmly in the spotlight.

Music observers have described “Let’s Have It” as a vibrant, positive record that blends Jay Rox’s signature energy with Way Dee’s fresh appeal.

The collaboration marks another strong pairing for both artists, following their earlier work together on Way Dee’s “Wele.”

Fans have welcomed the new drop with excitement, praising the chemistry between the veteran hitmaker and the rising star.

Many are calling it a timely summer anthem and have begun streaming it heavily across platforms.

The single arrives as Jay Rox continues to stay active with consistent releases, further solidifying his place as one of Zambia’s most reliable and innovative voices in music.

Chef 187 still on Broke Nolukumbwa?



By Alex Maboshe

Zambian hardcore rapper Chef 187, also known as Numero Uno born Kondwani Kaira, has released the official music video for “Inkama Nkaya Nasho Ku Nshinshi.”

The track is taken from his widely celebrated 2023 album Broke Nolukumbwa, a project that dominated airwaves, nightclubs and music charts upon release.

The album delivered several standout hits, including “Too Busy,” “Not Important” and “Niwe Natemwa,” along with a strong lineup of guest features that fans still praise.

The arrival of the video nearly three years later has surprised some listeners who had been expecting new material from the artist.

Others welcomed the release, saying they had long hoped the bold anthem would receive an official visual treatment.

Supporters have described the video as deep and fitting, noting that it strengthens the song’s message and adds greater emotional weight.

The release has also sparked fresh questions among fans “Is a new album still on the way, or should they expect more videos from the already iconic Broke Nolukumbwa project?”

Observe objectively, ECZ tells Observers

By Ruth Kambita

The Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) has urged international election observers to remain objective and impartial when assessing the 2026 General Elections, saying credible observation is vital for peace and public confidence.

Speaking during a briefing with International Election Observers at Mulungushi International Conference Center in Lusaka today, ECZ Chairperson Mwangala Zaloumis described observers as “critical stakeholders” whose independent testimony helps validate

electoral credibility.

She said the ECZ is committed to ensuring the polls are free, fair and credible and pledged to facilitate accredited missions within the law.

Meanwhile ECZ Chief Electoral Officer Brown Kasaro said no legal suit has been filed against the delimitation outcome, which created 70 new constituencies.

Briefings covered accreditation, results management, and procedures around ballot arrival, verification and counting processes the ECZ says observers should be allowed to witness to boost transpar-

ency.

The commission warned that election periods can foster misinformation across media platforms and urged observers to seek clarification through official channels to ensure accurate assessments.

ECZ Voter Education Manager Emma Mwiinga added that candidates contesting elective parliamentary seats are ineligible for proportional representation nominations. The ECZ reaffirmed its commitment to impartiality, professionalism and openness in administering the election.

OMC growth must benefit locals - Mubanga

By Luyando Mukuka

The rapid expansion of Zambia’s petroleum sector must translate into meaningful opportunities for Zambian businesses, Oil Marketing Companies Association president Dr Kafula Mubanga has said.

Dr Mubanga says the growing number of Oil Marketing

Companies (OMCs) should not be viewed merely as evidence of investment in the sector if local businesses remain unable to participate meaningfully in the industry.

He says the government needs to introduce deliberate policy measures to strengthen local content and enable Zambian-owned companies, particularly small and medium enterprises, to benefit

from opportunities emerging in the petroleum sector.

“The increase in the number of oil marketing companies does not, on its own, address the issue of local content,” Dr Mubanga said.

He said some of the requirements under the existing policy framework remain too high for local SMEs, making it difficult for them to compete effectively and participate in industry opportunities.

“When you look at the policy framework, there are very high requirements that are required for local or small and medium enterprises to participate,” he said.

Dr Mubanga said Zambia risks recording impressive growth in the petroleum sector without achieving corresponding growth in local businesses.

He said the situation requires a deliberate approach to ensure that investment translates into local ownership, enterprise development and broader economic benefits.

“Most of the things are not creating local businesses. They are not empowering local businesses,” Dr Mubanga said.

His concerns come as the Energy Regulation Board (ERB) says Zambia now has more than 620 OMCs and over 700 filling stations operating across the country. However, Dr Mubanga says the next challenge is ensuring that the expansion of the sector goes beyond numbers and delivers tangible opportunities for Zambians.

He says meaningful local participation will be critical to determining whether the sector’s growth produces lasting economic benefits.

Clergy Parley hopeful pledges quality health delivery

By Luyando Mukuka

Independent parliamentary candidate for Kabushi Constituency Pastor Boyd Ngosa and independent mayoral candidate Nfungo Mulenga have pledged to improve service delivery in Ndola if elected in the August 13 general elections.

Pastor Ngosa says medical facilities in Kabushi need to be upgraded to meet the needs of the growing population.

Speaking to the Real Times newspaper, Pastor Ngosa identified Chichele and Kantolomba as areas that need 24-hour operating clinics.

He has also called on the government to expedite the completion of the cancer hospital in Ndola, saying Copperbelt residents should not continue travelling to Lusaka for specialised treatment.

Pastor Ngosa has urged residents to vote for him, saying he has a vision to ensure that Kabushi Constituency is “renewed into a city within a city.”

Meanwhile, independent mayoral candidate Nfungo

Mulenga says his administration will prioritise finding alternative avenues for resources to address Ndola’s growing service delivery challenges if elected.

Speaking to the Real Times newspaper, Mr. Mulenga says Ndola District cannot continue to rely solely on central government grants and the Constituency Development Fund (CDF) to finance key projects in waste management, road infrastructure, water supply and markets.

He says the council must leverage public-private partnerships, attract investors and strengthen revenue collection systems to ensure resources meant for service delivery are properly accounted for and effectively used.

Mr. Mulenga says poor drainage, uncollected garbage and dilapidated roads have persisted because of inadequate funding and poor planning.

He has also pledged to prioritise transparency and accountability in council operations, saying every Kwacha collected should work for the people of Ndola.

‘Wait! More teachers’

By Alex Maboshe

The Teaching Service Commission has suspended the recruitment of 2,000 teachers that began last year as it works out how many additional teachers will be employed under President Hakainde Hichilema’s directive to hire unemployed teachers identified during his campaign rallies.

Commission Chairperson Daphne Chimuka said the 2,000 teachers selected under

the 2025 recruitment exercise had already been chosen by District Human Resource Management Committees and had completed the selection process.

Ms Chimuka stated that teachers to be recruited under the presidential directive will instead be absorbed into this year’s planned intake of 3,500 teachers, resulting in an overall increase in the number of teachers to be employed.

She added that the Commission will first validate the

credentials of those offered employment under the presidential directive before they are appointed to the public service.

The Commission is working with Provincial Administrations to compile lists of beneficiaries.

The Teaching Council of Zambia will then verify their professional registration, while the Examinations Council of Zambia will authenticate their academic qualifications before any appointments are made.

Blaze kills mom, baby survives

By Ruth Kambita

A 32-year-old woman has died while her two-year-old daughter has survived with burns after a grass-thatched hut they were in burned down at Namalyo Fishing Camp in Mukamono Village, Hamusonde Chieftdom, Monze District.

The fire is reported to have occurred on August 6, 2026, between about 20:00 and

22:20 hours.

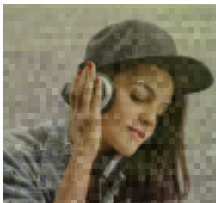
Evelyn Malama now the deceased, a fish trader who lived in the thatched structure, which she reportedly used both as a residence and for smoking fish.

According to Southern Province Police Commanding Officer Moono Namalongo, Preliminary information suggests the blaze may have started inside the hut.

Neighbours rescued Ms

Malama’s two-year-old daughter after her cries alerted them to the fire. The child sustained burn injuries to both legs and was taken for medical treatment.

Mr Namalongo said investigations are ongoing to determine the exact cause of the fire and the circumstances that led to Ms Malama’s death.



Saturday Specials

We are hiring in five days!



By Dr Orleans Mfuné

It is five days to the ballot and the die is cast. There is no turning back! It is certain we will be hiring a new set of MPs and Civic leaders, and should the first round vote be conclusive, a President for the next five years!

While this is certainly an exciting time, the remaining few days could also be the most difficult days for the nation.

Tensions, misinformation, perceived lack of transparency and political violence could all complicate this period and affect the nation's democratic credentials.

But the world is watching and the big question is: will Zambia hold on to its democratic credentials and deliver a fair and peaceful election?

The answer to this question depends on how all players involved approach the polling day.

The players include the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ), the Voters, the candidates and their supporters.

First, all players have the

responsibility of maintaining peace before, during and after the poll. While the period is certainly tense and many of us are on the edge, we have to avoid violence at all costs.

Leaders must reign in their supporters and allow the ballot to be the deciding factor. Our police too, must for once, demonstrate their professionalism by bringing to book perpetrators of political violence and protecting our citizens from any manner of harm. Peace, for me, is the most important factor that tests our democracy.

Given what is at stake, it is also important that all our systems and participating actors are ready to deliver a credible election.

The ECZ, in particular, as a key player in this process must do all it takes to ensure that all materials are at polling stations in time and all stations are ready for the day. Similarly, our electoral officers and polling agents must all be ready to handle not only the ballots but also the post-voting process that includes the counting, tabulation and communication of results.

For voters, August the 13th is our time.

You have heard the politicians speak, you have read about them, you have seen the way they conduct themselves and you possibly know their track-record, but time has come to hire or not hire them. And on that day, your mark on the ballot paper will be the deciding factor.

This is the only time when all of us become hiring officers. Our qualification and credentials as hiring officers

are the voter's card and NRC. Based on these credentials, we are being called to duty on the 13th. Lets deliver!

For me, this is a great responsibility which every voter must exercise with soberness, sound judgment and patriotism.

On the practical and preparatory side, let us use the remaining few days to make sure we have all the documentation and information to vote. Our voters cards and IDs must be ready and in an easy-to-access place.

We must also have the correct information on the polling station and our preferred candidates for all levels.

For our candidates, we leave you to deliver your final message in the next few days, but know that 13th August belongs to us the voters.

We know the anxieties that go with the polls, but you should remain open to all possible outcomes. If you are hired, thank God and thank the people of Zambia.

If you are not, accept the outcome, thank God and thank the people too. For every position, there can only be one winner at a time. 2026 may not be your turn, but 2031 may be yours and you will need God and the people for that too.

For our electoral observers, civil society and governance experts, help us have a successful election.

Avoid misinformation, be objective and do not be careless in your speeches. If you have to take sides, take the side of peace and truth. All we need is a peaceful and credible election!

The social contract



By Darlington Chiluba

The notion of a social contract arises as a means of answering one of the most important questions which is: who does government really represent?

Where does government draw the mandate to represent the nation and where is the evidence of consent from the people? Dictatorships and monarchs answer all these questions by masking their own needs as national needs thereby presenting themselves as the final answer to these questions.

Logically, however, a contract is not a document that imposes the will of one upon many others, especially in a social or national setting.

A contract is designed to be consensual at the very least. More than just a document, it is a guarantee that those with expectations have the indisputable right to withdraw their confidence if their expectations are not met.

Conversely, those entrusted with the mandate to achieve certain outcomes on behalf of others are granted every opportunity to do so objectively. A social contract can be simplified as a binding understanding that establishes obligations, expectations and consequences of performance or non-performance between and among vested parties.

Representative politics more accurately attempts to operate as a reciprocal system to various competing needs of a nation.

It proposes that people of a given area, ward or constituency are better represented by one of their own.

For instance, the Counselor, Mayor or Member of Parliament (MP) will be known to and familiar with their given electorate so that voters are not confronted with the option of voting for a stranger. In other words, people will

vote for a familiar individual whose leadership agenda will respond to the electorate.

The representative is given the mandate by the people through electoral consent. That consent is obtained by agreeing with the electorate on what must be achieved within the electoral cycle or lifetime of that constituency.

The mandate can take the form of a manifesto wherein those seeking elected office seek consent by detailing what they believe to be achievable during their tenure of office.

The manifesto, however, is not a legally binding document for all citizens-it is for the party in office and its supporters.

The opposition will not be bound by that manifesto and will earn their right to criticize it without necessarily breaking the law.

This is the nature of representative or participatory politics. It values and promotes divergent opinions so that even those in the minority are not isolated because of holding divergent beliefs. Admittedly, a manifesto is indeed a social contract between the elected and their constituents, but it is not one consented to by all citizens.

That being the case, it is only natural that a greater document binding all citizens to a unified ultimate purpose be created. A document not bound by, nor restricted to electoral cycles, but leans strongly on the continuity of the state and its people. That overarching document is the Constitution.

This is the ultimate document of inevitable consequence for the voter and those elected. It is the quintessential guarantor of vested interests and qualifies as an appropriate social contract. It transfers power to elected officials for a given period to

provide their mandate some justifiable action and legal comfort.

Article 260 of Zambian law which deals with Oath of office and Prescribed Oath establishes the point at which those who work for the people are held accountable by the constitution and to what extent.

More accurately, Chapter 5 of the laws of Zambia known as The Official Oaths Act sets out a schedule of the high offices for which oaths must be taken. These are Oath of President, of Vice-President, of the Minister or Deputy Minister, the Speaker of the National Assembly and the Judicial oath.

All of these are obviously high and important offices but only one oath, the Presidential oath has the following words "... having been constitutionally elected/re-elected..."

The rest of the oaths carry the word "appointed" (or nominated), meaning the absence of a direct link to the voters, or more crudely, the citizens.

This important point fundamentally separates the presidency from all other offices in that the transient incumbent is made personally responsible to the people, on oath.

Not only is the incumbent custodian of the constitution but also the personification of public interest. This is where the nation and its matters take precedence over partisan and other sectarian issues. The presidency, as anchored in the constitution, is a unifier. Failure in this high office can have lasting ramifications which can spew into the judiciary and legislature after all, these are appointees of public interest who swear allegiance to the President. If a president is sectarian or has proclivity towards their own political party than the nation, failure is inevitable.

If, for example, the sitting president makes an accusation against another citizen, least of all in parliament, the law has a weakness of taking the president's word as truth and the legislature and judiciary can be made conduits or accomplices to such accusations. This is a historically observable trend and weakness which the judiciary and legislature are yet to overcome. Implicitly, the President therefore holds the responsibility to uphold the implied conditions of the Social Contract with a view to represent the interests of all citizens regardless of their political affiliation, creed or color.

Where has the presidential debate gone?



TV Analysis

By Sam Phiri

Where are the presidential debates, Mr Costa Mwansa?

There was a time when Mr Mwansa's debates were unmissable: careful, combative exchanges in which aspirant presidents

tested their ideas and defended their manifestos before a national audience.

Those television debates became a civic ritual, a forum where candidates were obliged to address the country as whole rather than tailored constituencies.

In an age of social media and handheld devices, the value of such public scrutiny is greater than ever.

Debates like those once hosted by Mr Mwansa would now find a vast and engaged audience online, trend widely, and stimulate discussion among citizens who seek more than slogan and songs.

Such televised debates force politicians to look beyond short-term optics and explain, in plain terms, how they would steer the nation. It would have been very nice.

It is therefore striking that this year's contest with its lively field of aspirants and distinctive messages has not been accompanied by the kind of presidential debate that once captured the national imagination.

That omission is not merely a missed commercial opportunity for broadcasters; it is a loss for our democracy.

A well-produced debate both popularises

public broadcasting and strengthens citizens' ability to make informed choices.

Meanwhile, the media landscape has evolved. Increasingly, Zambians turn to social platforms for news, accessing content at any hour via smartphones.

That democratises access but also undermines editorial control: misinformation spreads rapidly when material is posted without verification.

Broadcast outlets that combine reach with rigour therefore matter more than ever.

ZNBC's "I Trending" segment, presented by Dominic, is an example of television adapting to the times: it curates social-media stories for the big screen and adds a youthful, accessible tone.

Such programming helps viewers who miss online chatter to catch up with context and verification.

Today we end with an appeal to Mr Mwansa that reviving presidential debates would be an ideal way to marry robust journalism with modern distribution serving both audiences and the health of our democracy.

Nkana crush Tafic, reach Tati River final in Botswana



Queens head home after WAFCON shock exit

By Benedict Tembo

The Zambia women's football team has departed Rabat for Lusaka following their exit from the ongoing TotalEnergies WAFCON 2026 in Morocco.

The Copper Queens contingent, which departed from Mohammed V International Airport in Casablanca yesterday, is expected to arrive in Lusaka tomorrow.

Meanwhile, all the foreign-based players, with the exception of captain Barbra Banda, are returning directly to their respective clubs.

According to FAZ media, Banda will travel via Lusaka for personal reasons before returning to the United States.

Zambia's WAFCON campaign ended on Wednesday after the Copper Queens narrowly missed out on a place in the knockout stage despite a strong showing in the group phase.

The Copper Queens opened their campaign with an emphatic 6-0 victory over Egypt before suffering a narrow 1-0 defeat to Nigeria. They concluded the group stage with a 2-1 win over Malawi.

Zambia, Nigeria and Malawi all finished on six points, with CAF's head-to-head tiebreaker rules separating the three teams.

Malawi advanced as Group 'C' winners, Nigeria finished second, while Zambia exited the competition.



By Benedict Tembo

Nkana FC have booked their place in the Tati River Cup final after a resounding 3-0 victory over Tafic FC in the first semi-final at the Obed Itani Chilume Stadium in Francistown, Botswana.

Kalampa started brightly and took control of the contest, with Francis Bubu Mutalange breaking the deadlock on the stroke of half-time to give Nkana a 1-0 lead at the interval.

Tafic looked to find a way back after the restart, but Nkana remained composed and continued to threaten in the final third.

Captain Lazarous Kambole doubled Kalampa's advantage in the 75th minute, putting Elijah Tana's



side firmly in control.

Nkana then put the result beyond doubt seven minutes later when defender Leonard Makonga found the back of the net in the 83rd minute to complete a convincing 3-0 victory.

The result sees Kalampa advance to the inaugural Tati River Cup final, where they will face either Tonota FC or Township Rollers, who meet in the second semi-final later.

Meanwhile, Nkana coach Elijah Tana has challenged his players to be more clinical in front of goal as Kalampa turned their attention to the final.

Tana was pleased with the overall performance following the 3-0 victory over Tafic in the semi-final but believes his side could have made the result more comfortable by taking its early chances.

Tana revealed that Nkana had deliberately

planned to press high from the start and looked for an early breakthrough, but failed to capitalise on several opportunities created during the opening stages.

"We planned to play high and we were looking forward to an early goal, but we didn't utilise the chances we had. I think we had four clear chances," Tana said.

Despite the missed opportunities, he felt the team grew into the game and improved as the match progressed, eventually finding the goals needed to secure a place in the final.

"Overall, we played well. We need to work harder for us to carry the day in the finals," he added.

Nkana will face either Tonota or Township Rollers in the Tati River Cup final as they look to finish their Botswana tour with silverware.